

# Shuaib Salar Ahmed

Austin, TX • shuaib.salar.ahmed@gmail.com • LinkedIn: [Shuaib Ahmed](#) • Github: [Portfolio](#) Website: [Portfolio](#)

## ***JUNIOR NETWORK ENGINEER | NOC ANALYST | NETWORK SUPPORT***

### **Professional Summary:**

CCNA and Security+ certified network professional with onsite troubleshooting experience across retail, healthcare, and banking environments. Restored VoIP and network-printing services, prevented a peak retail sales-window outage, and coordinated a 300+ endpoint deployment. Builds Cisco routing/switching and FortiGate security labs to deepen operational troubleshooting skills.

### **Certifications:**

Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA)  
CompTIA Security+  
Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals  
NSE4  
Cisco Certified Network Professional (CCNP) In Progress

### **Networking Labs/Projects**

[Arp-Lab](#) - Demonstrated ARP resolution and MAC/IP mapping across hosts, switches, and routers

[SSH Lab](#) - Configured secure remote access on Cisco devices, including key generation and authentication

[Topology Drawer](#) - Developed Python-based network topology tool enabling rapid visualization and AI-assisted topology generation

[Rapid-PVST Lab](#) - Built and validated a Rapid PVST+ campus switching lab in Cisco Modeling Labs, confirming root-bridge election, forwarding vs. alternate port roles, blocked redundant paths, and loop-free Layer 2 redundancy across a four-switch VLAN 10 topology.

[Active-Directory Lab](#) - Recovered a broken Windows 11 Active Directory domain client by isolating DNS-driven AD discovery and stale machine-account state, then rejoining lab.local and validating successful LAB\faraz authentication with expected Forti\_Guests group membership.

### **Professional Experience:**

***Field Nation — Independent Network Technician (Contractor) — Jan 2025 - Present***

***Clients: Best Buy - Walgreens - Gentiva Health Services - Frost Bank***

Delivered 10+ onsite contracts across retail, healthcare and banking; focused on minimizing downtime, speeding time-to-restore, and reducing repeat dispatches.

#### **Best Buy**

- Prevented a likely site outage during a Black Friday sales window by isolating power-related router instability during a Best Buy deployment and recommending corrective action before turnover.

#### **Gentiva Health Services**

- Restored hospital VoIP and internet service during a live support escalation by tracing MAC addresses to the correct switchport, identifying a disconnected switch uplink from NOC troubleshooting, and replacing a failing legacy IP phone with a working unit to accelerate recovery for patient-care communications.

#### **Walgreens**

- Restored Walgreens network-printing service under live workload without hardware replacement, minimizing operational disruption and avoiding unnecessary replacement effort.

#### **Gentiva Health Services (2nd Location)**

- Resolved an out-of-scope endpoint connectivity issue using an AI-assisted troubleshooting workflow and end-user guidance, preventing escalation and a repeat dispatch.

#### **Frost Bank**

- Selected as lead technician by Help Desk leadership to coordinate deployment of 300+ thin clients, assigning tasks and ensuring quality across multiple technicians

#### **Verizon 5G Site Survey**

- Conducted detailed Verizon 5G site survey for carrier deployment planning, documenting conduit pathways, telecom-room/rack layout, cabling constraints, equipment-placement options, and implementation details while coordinating with remote technical support to clarify scope and produce accurate field documentation.

### **Technical Skills:**

**Networking/Cisco:** TCP/IP, OSI, IPv4/IPv6, subnetting, VLANs, 802.1Q trunking, inter-VLAN routing, STP/RSTP, EtherChannel/LACP, NAT/PAT, DHCP, DNS, ARP, ICMP, Cisco IOS, interface configuration, static routing, OSPF, Python

**Troubleshooting/Support:** Layer 1-3 troubleshooting, connectivity verification, MAC/ARP validation, port identification, cable/port tracing, log collection, root-cause analysis, ticket-driven support, remote engineer coordination, technical documentation

**Windows / Active Directory:** Windows troubleshooting, domain join/rejoin, AD DNS dependency, LDAP/SRV record validation, machine-account troubleshooting, secure-channel repair, ADUC basics, user/group membership validation, endpoint connectivity

**Security / Cloud / Endpoints:** FortiGate firewall policy concepts, web filtering, DNS filtering, application control, traffic/session analysis, VoIP/IP phones, printers/network printing, POS/peripherals, access control concepts, network security, Azure fundamentals

## **Education**

***Houston Community College — A.S. Computer Science***

***University of Texas at Dallas — B.S. Data Science (In Progress)***